

AoE2 Tournament Agent

Player Guide

Age of Empires II: Definitive Edition — Community Tournament

Everything you need to register, play your matches, and compete in your division — step by step.

You can always re-download this guide from your Player Portal at the top of any tab.

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1. How the Tournament Works (Quick Overview)

Phase	What Happens	Your Action
Register	Create your account on the tournament website	Fill in the registration form
Placement Games	Play 5 free games to determine your ELO and division	Play matches, report results
Pay Entry Fee	Pay two PayPal fees to join YOUR division's bracket	Click Pay via PayPal buttons in your portal
Wait for Confirmation	Organiser checks PayPal and confirms receipt	Click 'I've Paid Both Fees'
Settings Vote	Vote on map, resources, and speed for your division	Vote in your portal
Swiss Bracket	7 rounds of play against players at your skill level	Play matches, report results
Top 8 Playoff	Top 8 finishers play a single-elimination final	Play and report if you qualify
Champion	Division winner is crowned, prizes distributed	Win the Grand Final

Placement games are completely free in every division. Once you're classified, your entry fee is specific to YOUR division — some divisions may even be free, others may have a fee. Check your portal for your exact amount.

2. Step 1 — Register Your Account

- 1 Open the tournament URL in your browser (shared in your Discord server).
- 2 Click the **Register** button on the home page.
- 3 Fill in all the fields:

Field	What to Enter
Player Name	Your in-game name or nickname
Discord Tag	Your full Discord tag (e.g. TheViper#1337)
Email Address	Your email — used to log in. Must be real and unique.
Password	Choose a password (minimum 6 characters)
Confirm Password	Type your password again to confirm
Favourite Civ	Your preferred civilization (shown on your profile)
Known ELO	Your current ELO if you know it. Leave at 800 if unsure.
Timezone	Your timezone — match times will show in your local time

- 1 Click **Create Account**.
- 2 A success screen appears. Click **Log In Now**.

Use your real email. This is your login and how the organiser may contact you.

3. Step 2 — Log Into Your Portal

- 1 Click **Login** in the navigation bar.
- 2 Enter your email address and password.
- 3 Click **Sign In**.

At the top of your portal, you'll always see a ■ **Player Guide** box with a download button — this is the PDF you're reading now, available anytime.

Below that, your portal has four tabs:

Tab	What It Shows
Dashboard	Your stats, pending matches with lobby info, settings vote, placement progress
My Matches	All your upcoming and completed matches. Report results here.
Standings	Your division's Swiss standings with your position highlighted
Profile	Your account details and fee payment status

Bookmark the tournament URL. You will come back here to check your next match, report results, and track standings throughout the tournament.

4. Step 3 — Your Placement Matches

After the organiser closes registration and generates the schedule, your placement matches will appear in your portal dashboard.

Each placement match shows you:

- 1 Your opponent's name, ELO, and timezone
- 2 The scheduled date and time **in your local timezone**
- 3 The lobby name and password
- 4 All game settings (map, resources, speed, spectator delay)
- 5 A built-in **message box** to talk directly with your opponent

You need to complete **5 placement matches** to be assigned to your division. After each match, both players report the result from their portals.

Message your opponent right on the platform — no need to find them on Discord. Every match has a built-in chat box where you can say hello, confirm you're ready, or suggest a different time if you need to reschedule. See Section 5 for details.

4b. Messaging Your Opponent On the Platform

Every match — placement or tournament — has a built-in message box right below the lobby information. You no longer need Discord to coordinate with your opponent.

- 1 Open your portal and find your match (Dashboard or My Matches tab).
- 2 Scroll down past the lobby info — you'll see a ■ **Message [Opponent Name]** box.
- 3 Type your message and press Enter or click Send.
- 4 Your message is saved instantly and appears in the thread for both of you.

Use it to:

- 1 Confirm you're both ready to play
- 2 Suggest a different time if the scheduled one doesn't work
- 3 Ask which lobby settings they'd prefer if anything is flexible
- 4 Say good luck before the game!

Messages aren't instant like a live chat app. They save right away, but your opponent will see new messages the next time they open or refresh their portal — similar to email. Plan ahead a little if you're trying to coordinate a specific time.

5. How to Set Up a Game Lobby

Player 1 creates the lobby. Player 2 joins. The lobby box in your portal shows who creates.

- 1 Open Age of Empires II: Definitive Edition.
- 2 Click **Multiplayer** → **Create Game**.
- 3 Set the game settings exactly as shown in your lobby box.
- 4 Type the exact lobby name and password shown in your portal.
- 5 **Set spectator delay to at least 10 minutes** before making the lobby public.
- 6 Enable **Record Game**.
- 7 Create the lobby and wait for your opponent to join.

Recording is required. Both players must enable Record Game before starting. If there is a dispute, the recording is the only way to resolve it.

6. Game Settings for Placement Matches

Use the settings shown in your portal lobby box. Default placement match settings are:

Setting	Default Value	Notes
Map	Random Map	Game picks randomly — fair for everyone
Resources	Standard	Normal starting resources
Spectator Delay	10 minutes minimum	REQUIRED — set this in lobby settings
Recording	Required	Enable before starting the game

Always use what your lobby box says — not these defaults, since the organiser can customise these per tournament.

7. Step 4 — Reporting a Result

- 1 Log into your portal.
- 2 Go to Dashboard or My Matches tab.
- 3 Find the match you just played.
- 4 Click **I Won** or **I Lost**.
- 5 Wait for your opponent to confirm.

Both players must report. If only you report, the match shows 'Waiting for opponent to confirm.'

8. What Happens When Both Players Agree

- 1 The result is **automatically confirmed** — no admin needed.
- 2 ELO ratings are updated for both players.
- 3 Placement progress bar advances, or standings update immediately.
- 4 The match shows a gold trophy and the winner's name.

This is the normal flow. Most matches resolve in seconds once both players report.

9. What Happens If Results Don't Match (Dispute)

- 1 The match turns red with a DISPUTED label.
- 2 The tournament admin is notified automatically.
- 3 Save your game recording immediately if you haven't already.
- 4 Send your recording to the admin when requested.
- 5 The admin reviews both recordings and picks the correct winner.

Always record your games. If you don't have a recording and there is a dispute, the decision will most likely go against you.

10. Step 5 — Your Division Bracket

After completing your 5 placement games, you are automatically assigned to the division that matches your ELO.

Division	ELO Range	What It Means
Bronze	0 – 499	Newer or developing players
Silver	500 – 799	Intermediate skill level
Gold	800 – 1099	Strong competitive players
Diamond	1100+	Elite-level players

Your division may have different names, ELO ranges, AND a different entry fee — every division can be priced independently by the organiser. Check the tournament home page or your portal for your specific division's cost.

11. Voting on Division Settings

- 1 Log into your portal.
- 2 On your Dashboard, find the **Vote on Settings** section.
- 3 Vote on Map, Resources, and Speed.
- 4 The leading option in each category is shown to all voters.

Voting matters. The winning option is used for every match in your division for the entire season.

12. Swiss Rounds — How They Work

Swiss is a format where **everyone plays every round** — no one is eliminated until the end.

Round	Who You Play	Why
Round 1	A randomly assigned opponent	First round — no data yet
Rounds 2–7	Someone with the same win-loss record	Keeps matches competitive
After 7 rounds	Top 8 advance to playoff	Buchholz score breaks ties

Even if you lose some matches, keep playing. Every win counts toward your standings.

13. Your Tournament Match Lobby

Info	Example	What It Means
Lobby Name	NA-KINGS-R03-THEVvC LAN	The name of the lobby you create/join
Lobby Password	castle42	Password to enter the lobby
Map / Resources / Speed	Voted on by your division	Settings locked for the season
Spectator Delay	10 min min	MUST be set in lobby settings

Player 1 creates the lobby. Player 2 joins. Your match card tells you which role you have.

14. Reporting Tournament Match Results

- 1 After the game, log into your portal.
- 2 Go to Dashboard or My Matches tab.
- 3 Click **I Won** or **I Lost**.
- 4 Wait for your opponent to confirm — both reports must match to finalize.

15. Standings and the Top 8 Playoff

Check your standings in **My Portal** → **Standings**.

- 1 Your position, Swiss record, Buchholz score, and current ELO
- 2 A green highlight if you're in the Top 8 playoff zone
- 3 A note showing how many spots away you are if outside Top 8

If you finish in the top 8 of your division's Swiss bracket, you advance to the single-elimination playoff: Quarterfinals → Semifinals → Grand Final.

Win the Grand Final and a champion banner with your name appears on the tournament home page.

16. Entry Fees — How to Pay via PayPal

Your tournament entry fee depends on YOUR specific division — some divisions may be free, others may charge a fee. The fee is split into two separate PayPal payments:

Fee	Goes To
Platform Admin Fee	The platform that runs the tournament software
Prize Pool Fee	Your division's prize pool, paid out to winners

How to pay, step by step:

- 1 Log into your portal. If your division has a fee, a **Pay Your Entry Fee** section appears on your Dashboard.
- 2 You'll see two cards: Platform Admin Fee and Prize Pool Fee, each with a **Pay via PayPal** button.
- 3 Click each button and complete the PayPal payment. The amount and a tracking note (your email, the tournament name, your Discord tag) are pre-filled automatically.
- 4 Once both payments are sent, click **'I've Paid Both Fees'**.
- 5 Your status changes to ■ **Submitted**.
- 6 The organiser checks PayPal and confirms receipt. Your status then changes to ■ **Received**.

You need Received status before you can play in the paid bracket. Placement games remain free regardless.

Check your current status anytime in **My Portal → Profile**.

17. Reporting a Player for Misconduct

- 1 In your pending match card, find the **Report [Player Name]** button.
- 2 Describe what happened clearly in the text box.
- 3 Click **Submit Report**.
- 4 The report goes to the tournament admin for review.

Reason to Report	Examples
No-show	Opponent did not appear and did not respond on Discord
Cheating	Modified game files, exploiting bugs
Harassment	Abusive language in Discord or in-game chat

18. Downloading This Guide Again

This guide is always available from inside your player portal — no need to ask the organiser for it.

- 1 Log into your portal.
- 2 At the very top of the page, above the Dashboard/Matches/Standings/Profile tabs, you'll see a gold-bordered ■ **Player Guide** box.
- 3 Click ■■ **Download Player Guide (PDF)** to get the latest version anytime.

19. Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
I forgot my password.	Contact the tournament organiser or admin to reset it.
Where do I message my opponent?	Every match card has a message box below the lobby info — no Discord needed.
Will my opponent see my message right away?	Not instantly — it saves immediately but they'll see it next time they open or refresh their portal.
My placement opponent isn't responding.	Use the message box on your match card first. After 48 hours with no reply, report a no-show.
What if I can't play at the scheduled time?	Use the message box on your match card to agree on a different time with your opponent.
I won but my opponent reported a loss for me.	A dispute is created. Save your recording and send it to the admin.
How is ELO calculated?	Standard chess ELO formula. Beating a higher-rated player gains more ELO.
Can I play in multiple divisions?	No — you're assigned to exactly one division based on placement ELO.
Why do I pay two separate PayPal payments?	One funds the platform, one funds your division's prize pool. Tracked separately for transparency.
Is the fee the same for every division?	No — each division sets its own prize fee. Check your specific division's cost in your portal.
Can I see the live prize pool before I pay?	Yes — shown on the tournament home page and each division card, growing as payments are confirmed.
Where do I find the lobby name and password?	In your portal Dashboard or My Matches tab, on the match card for that game.

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